

32 Conditional tenses

You can use the third conditional to describe an unreal past, or events that did not happen. This is useful for talking about regrets you have about the past.

 **New language** The third conditional

Aa Vocabulary Environmental threats

 **New skill** Talking about an unreal past

32.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE THIRD CONDITIONAL

SECOND CONDITIONAL

The second conditional is used to describe unreal situations in the present.



If I lived in New York,
I would go running in Central Park.

THIRD CONDITIONAL

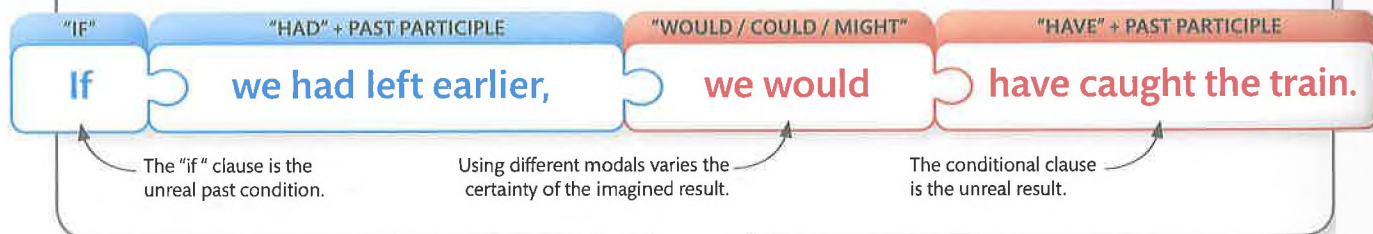
Use the third conditional to describe unreal situations in the past.



If we had left earlier,
we would have caught the train.



32.2 HOW TO FORM THE THIRD CONDITIONAL



32.3 ANOTHER WAY TO SAY THE THIRD CONDITIONAL

The past perfect continuous can also follow "if" in the third conditional.

If you'd been wearing a coat, you would have stayed warm.

We would've caught the train if we'd left on time.

Often "have" is contracted when spoken.

Sentences in the third conditional can be reordered without a comma so the "if" clause is second.

